MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 6

"Before Tomorrow"

Episode 1x06. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x06. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, August 8, 2005, 4:12 AM through Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 1:02 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 43 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x05

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on July 1, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, August 8, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Kingston Wade (new)	Patient: stage IV neuroblastoma	Mar 21, 1995	10
Monique Wade (new)	Kingston's mother	Jul 14, 1972	33
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Theodore 'Teddy' Glover (new)	Patient: CAD, MI, CABG	Feb 2, 1937	68
Percival Lane (new)	Teddy's partner since 1963	Jun 12, 1935	70
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (13 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	27
Gabrielle Foster (new)	Patient: brain AVM	Dec 9, 1970	34
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Nurse Debra 'Deb' Lyons	Charge Nurse	Sep 14, 1960	44
Beatrice Glover-Hollins (new)	Teddy's sister	Mar 3, 1941	64
Dr. Hampton (new)	Elxa's OB, Jamaica Hospital	Apr 20, 1950	55
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Victor Donohue	Founder, Victor Donohue Foundation (on-screen debut)	May 30, 1933	72
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	46
Col. Bernard Ashe, Ret. (new)	Retired astronaut (V.O.; fictional)	Oct 1, 1946	58
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Mother Odetta Banks (new)	Patient: hip repair	Jan 30, 1914	91

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47

Also appearing: a 1010 WINS radio anchor (V.O.), ICU nurses, a NASA TV commentator (V.O.), and a Town Car driver. Mentioned: Aaliyah and Ahmad Cummings, and Loretta Cummings (Gary, IN).

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 4:12 AM

A child's hospital room turned into a launch pad. Every inch of wall is covered with NASA posters, glow-in-the-dark stars, a hand-drawn diagram of the Space Shuttle, and a printed countdown taped to the window: "DISCOVERY LANDING: TUESDAY, AUGUST 9." A small TV is tuned to NASA TV.

In the bed: KINGSTON WADE (10), bald from chemo, oxygen cannula, painfully thin, wide awake, wearing a NASA mission-patch T-shirt three sizes too big. His mother, MONIQUE WADE (33), sleeps upright in the recliner.

Marc (26), on call, comes in quietly to check the IV pump. Kingston whispers:

KINGSTON
Dr. Bullock. They moved the landing.

MARC
(whispering, sitting on the edge of the bed)
What happened?

KINGSTON
Weather in Florida. They might land in California instead. Edwards Air Force Base. The Mojave Desert. (eyes shining) That's where they landed the very first shuttle in 1981.

MARC (V.O.)
Doctors talk a lot about time. Time of onset. Time of death. Time to OR.

MARC (V.O.)
What we almost never say out loud is how little of it any of us actually has.

KINGSTON
(beat, quieter)
Dr. Bullock. Am I going to see it land?

Marc looks at him. At the countdown on the window. At the monitor. At the oxygen.

MARC
(beat)
Yeah, man. You're going to see it land.

Kingston smiles and closes his eyes. Marc sits there for a long moment, watching him breathe. Then he looks at the countdown. TUESDAY, AUGUST 9. Thirty hours away.

2 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 5:02 AM

Harmony (26) and Raven (25), dressed for work, stand by the kitchen radio, listening. 1010 WINS.

RADIO ANCHOR (V.O.)
...ABC News anchor Peter Jennings died last night at his home in Manhattan, four months after announcing he had lung cancer. He was sixty-seven. Jennings anchored World News Tonight for twenty-two years, and on September 11th, 2001, he stayed on the air for more than sixty hours...

Raven turns it down. Harmony is staring at the radio.

HARMONY
(quiet)
I watched him on 9/11. All day. In my mother's living room. Waiting to hear about Alicia.

RAVEN
(gently)
He told everybody he had cancer in April. On TV. And four months later...

HARMONY
(beat)
Four months. (beat) You think you have time. Then you don't.

She picks up her keys. Raven watches her.

RAVEN
You're going to tell him, aren't you.

HARMONY
(beat)
Tell who what?

RAVEN
Harmony.

HARMONY
(not looking at her, heading for the door)
I'm going to be late.

3 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 8 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 6:18 AM

THEODORE "TEDDY" GLOVER (68), a retired Juilliard music teacher with a silver beard, sits up in bed in silk pajamas, eating hospital Jell-O with aristocratic disgust. In the chair beside him, holding his hand without apology: PERCIVAL LANE (70), dignified, in a three-piece suit at six in the morning. Amond (26) reviews the chart. Robert (49) reads the cath report.

ROBERT
Three-vessel coronary artery disease, Mr. Glover. Left main involvement. You need a bypass. Soon. This week.

TEDDY
(to Percival)
You see? I told you it was the brisket at Sammy's.

PERCIVAL
It was forty-two years of brisket at Sammy's, Teddy.

AMOND
(reading the intake form)
Mr. Glover, under emergency contact you've written "Percival Lane, partner." Under health care proxy, you've left it blank. Do you have a signed health care proxy form? Or a living will?

Teddy and Percival look at each other.

TEDDY
We've been meaning to. For about forty years.

PERCIVAL
(dry)
We kept thinking there'd be time.

ROBERT
(gently)
Mr. Glover, I'd strongly recommend completing one before surgery. Under New York law, if you can't make decisions for yourself and you haven't named a proxy, the hospital looks to your family.

TEDDY
Percival IS my family.

ROBERT
(beat)
I know, sir. But the law doesn't. Not in 2005. Not without that piece of paper.

Percival's hand tightens on Teddy's.

4 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - THE BOARD - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 6:34 AM

Elxa (27), thirteen weeks pregnant, at the Board. Black ribbon pinned to her scrub top. Several of the staff are wearing them. Peter Jennings anchored their whole childhoods. Marc comes in looking like he hasn't slept.

ELXA
Bullock, you look like death.

MARC
Kingston Wade asked me if he's going to see Discovery land.

Elxa stops writing.

ELXA
(quiet)
What did you tell him?

MARC
Yes.

ELXA
(beat)
Marc. His last CT showed mets in both lungs and his liver. Crump thinks he has days.

MARC
The landing's tomorrow at eight-eleven a.m. Eastern. Edwards Air Force Base, if Florida stays bad. I looked it up.

ELXA
And if he doesn't have until tomorrow at eight-eleven?

MARC
(beat)
Then I lied to a ten-year-old. (beat) So he has to.

Elxa looks at her brother for a long time. Then writes on the Board: "WADE, K. -- 714 -- COMFORT CARE -- BULLOCK."

ELXA
Then keep him comfortable until eight-eleven.

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

5 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEUROSURGERY CLINIC - EXAM ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 7:15 AM

GABRIELLE FOSTER (34), a Long Island Rail Road conductor in uniform, sits on the exam table holding a manila envelope of MRI films. Next to her, a camcorder bag. Graves (52) studies the films on the lightbox. Esther (25) beside him.

GRAVES
An arteriovenous malformation. A tangle of abnormal vessels in your left motor cortex, right next to the part of your brain that moves your right arm and leg. It bled last month. That was the seizure on the train platform.

GABRIELLE
And if you take it out?

GRAVES
We embolize first, glue off the feeding vessels, and then remove it surgically on Wednesday. The risk of weakness on your right side is about ten percent. The risk of it bleeding again, if we leave it, is about four percent a year, and every bleed could kill you.

GABRIELLE
(very steady)
So I take the surgery.

GRAVES
I would.

She nods. Then she unzips the camcorder bag and takes out a Sony MiniDV Handycam.

GABRIELLE
Then before Wednesday, I need someone to help me record some tapes.

ESTHER
Tapes?

GABRIELLE
For my kids. Jaylen's eight. Simone's five. (beat) If I come out of surgery and I can't use my right hand, or I can't talk right, or I don't come out at all... I want them to have their mother saying everything I'd want to say to them. Birthdays. Graduations. Their wedding days. (beat) I'm not going to be the mother who meant to.

Esther looks at Graves. Graves looks at the camcorder for a long moment.

GRAVES
(to Esther, quietly)
Dr. Smilley has steady hands.

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 7:40 AM

Dr. Isaiah Crump (61) walks with Marc, both of them looking at Kingston's chart. Crump's bow tie is black today.

CRUMP
Stage four neuroblastoma. Diagnosed at age four. Remission at six. Relapsed at eight. We've done everything, Marc. Chemo. Stem cell transplant. Radiation. The new trial drug. His body is done.

MARC
He wants to see the shuttle land.

CRUMP
I know. He's told me every day for three weeks. (beat) His oxygen requirement has doubled since yesterday. His liver numbers are climbing. Days. Possibly hours.

MARC
What can we do?

CRUMP
Morphine for the breathlessness. Keep him comfortable. Keep his mother close. (beat) And, Marc... let his mother make the decisions. Not him, and not you.

MARC
He's ten.

CRUMP
He's ten and dying, and she's thirty-three and about to lose her only child. (beat) The best thing you can do for both of them is not to promise anything you can't deliver.

Marc doesn't answer.

CRUMP
(stopping, looking at him)
You already promised him something.

MARC
(quiet)
I told him he'd see it land.

CRUMP
(sighing)
Oh, son.

7 INT. PELL PAVILION - 5TH FLOOR - ROOM 522 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 9:20 AM

A double room. In the bed by the window: MOTHER ODETTA BANKS (91), tiny, sharp-eyed, a church mother in a lace headwrap, recovering from a hip repair. Raven changes her dressing.

MOTHER ODETTA
You're the one with the grandmother.

RAVEN
(smiling)
How did you know?

MOTHER ODETTA
You've said "my grandma says" four times in ten minutes. (beat) Is she living?

RAVEN
Yes, ma'am. In Savannah. Eighty-four.

MOTHER ODETTA
When's the last time you told her you love her?

RAVEN
(beat)
Easter. On the phone.

MOTHER ODETTA
(tsking)
It's August.

RAVEN
I've been busy. I'm an intern. We work thirty-hour shifts.

MOTHER ODETTA
Baby, I've outlived two husbands, four sisters, and a son. You know what I remember about every one of them? The last thing I said. And the thing I didn't. (beat) Call your grandmother.

RAVEN
(taping the dressing)
Yes, ma'am.

MOTHER ODETTA
Today.

RAVEN
(beat)
Yes, ma'am. Today.

Raven finishes. At the door she stops, pulls out her RAZR and dials right there in the hallway.

RAVEN
(into the phone)
Grandma? It's me. (beat) No, nothing's wrong. I just... I love you. That's all. (beat, laughing, tearing up) I know. I know you know.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - CENTRAL STATION - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 8:02 AM

Arianna (25) at the phone at the central station, her face tight. It's a long-distance call.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
...Aaliyah, slow down. When did you last see her? (beat) Saturday? It's Monday. (beat) Did you call the police? (beat) I know Gary PD doesn't care. Call them anyway. Did she take her meds? (beat) She threw them in the trash. Of course she did.

Kendra, passing with a med cart, slows when she sees Arianna's face.

ARIANNA
(into the phone, lower)
I can't come home, Aaliyah. I'm on call. I've got a twelve-month contract. If I leave... (beat) I know. I know she's our mother. (beat) Call Ahmad. Check the shelter on Broadway. Check the bus station. Call me back every two hours. Every two hours, Aaliyah.

She hangs up. Stares at the phone. Kendra puts a hand on her shoulder.

KENDRA
Your mom?

ARIANNA
(flat)
She's off her meds. She left the group home Saturday. Nobody's seen her. (beat) She's done it four times. She always turns up. Usually.

KENDRA
Usually?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Usually.

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 8 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 8:41 AM

Teddy is laughing at something Percival said. Mid-laugh, his face changes. He grips his chest. He goes gray.

TEDDY
(gasping)
Percy...

The monitor alarms. ST elevation on the screen. Percival is on his feet, hitting the call button.

PERCIVAL
HELP! Somebody, help!

Amond is in the room in seconds, then a NURSE, then a second nurse.

AMOND
(reading the monitor)
He's infarcting. Anterior ST elevation. Page Dr. Bullock and the cath lab. STAT. Aspirin, heparin, nitro.

Teddy's eyes roll. His pressure drops: 78/40. He's barely conscious.

TEDDY
(barely audible)
Percy... don't let them...

PERCIVAL
I'm right here, Teddy. I'm right here.

A third NURSE, CHARGE NURSE DEB LYONS (44), comes in, takes in the situation and touches Percival's arm.

DEB
Sir, I need you to step out.

PERCIVAL
I'm his partner.

DEB
(kindly but firm)
Sir, it's family only in a code situation. You'll have to wait outside.

AMOND
(sharp, not looking up from the patient)
He IS family. He stays.

Deb looks at Amond. Then at Percival, an old man in a three-piece suit, holding on to the bed rail with both hands. She steps back.

DEB
(quietly)
Stand by the wall, sir.

Robert sweeps in.

ROBERT
He's going to the cath lab, then the OR. Emergent bypass. Now.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC SURGERY - WAITING AREA - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 10:15 AM

Percival sits alone in the waiting area, his hat in his hands. The elevator opens. A woman in her sixties, sharp-featured, in a church suit and a large hat, strides out: BEATRICE GLOVER-HOLLINS (64). She goes to the desk.

BEATRICE
I'm Beatrice Glover-Hollins. Theodore Glover's sister. His next of kin. I got a call from the hospital that he's in surgery.

Percival stands, slowly.

PERCIVAL
Beatrice.

She turns. Sees him. Her face goes stony.

BEATRICE
Percival.

PERCIVAL
(with great dignity)
It's been thirty-one years.

BEATRICE
(cold)
Not long enough. (to the desk clerk) I'm his sister. I want to speak to his surgeon. And I don't want this man making any decisions about my brother's care. He's not family.

PERCIVAL
(quietly)
I've been his family since 1963.

BEATRICE
(not looking at him)
The law says otherwise.

Amond, coming out of the OR corridor in scrubs, hears the last line. He stops dead.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 2 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 11:02 AM

Teddy on bypass. His chest is open. Robert sews a vein graft onto a coronary artery the width of a strand of spaghetti. Amond holds the retractor. Coltrane plays low.

AMOND
(tense)
His sister is in the waiting room. She's telling the desk she's his next of kin and that his partner of forty-two years isn't family.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Under New York law, as of today, she's not wrong.

AMOND
That's insane.

ROBERT
It's 2005. (beat) If Mr. Glover wakes up and can speak for himself, it doesn't matter. He decides. If he doesn't wake up, if he has a stroke, if he ends up on a ventilator for weeks, the hospital is going to look to the sister for decisions. Because there's no proxy.

AMOND
And Percival?

ROBERT
(beat)
Percival will be a "friend." In the eyes of the law, he could be asked to wait in the lobby.

Amond's jaw works under his mask.

AMOND
They've been together since 1963. Since before the Stonewall riots.

ROBERT
I know. I spoke with Mr. Lane in pre-op. (beat) Dr. Baker. The best thing we can do for Mr. Lane is make sure Mr. Glover wakes up. So focus. Second graft. LAD.

Amond focuses.

12 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 11:30 AM

Kingston, propped on pillows, pale, breathing harder than this morning. Monique sits beside him. Marc and Harmony, who came with him to help, adjust the oxygen. Kingston is talking a mile a minute about the shuttle.

KINGSTON
...and the external tank shed foam again, which is why they're grounding the fleet after this flight, but Discovery's fine, they checked it with the laser on the robot arm, and they did a SPACEWALK under the shuttle to pull out the gap fillers, Stephen Robinson did it, he was the first person ever to do a repair on the belly of the shuttle in orbit...

HARMONY
(amazed)
How do you know all that?

KINGSTON
NASA TV. Twenty-four hours a day. My mom thinks it's boring.

MONIQUE
(exhausted, smiling)
It is boring, baby.

KINGSTON
It's the most exciting thing in the universe. (to Marc) What time do they land tomorrow?

MARC
Eight-eleven a.m. Eastern. If Florida's weather stays bad, Edwards in California.
Five-eleven a.m. their time.

KINGSTON
(grinning)
You looked it up.

MARC
I looked it up.

Kingston coughs. A wet, deep cough that goes on too long. Monique holds him. Harmony watches the monitor: oxygen saturation 88%. Marc turns up the oxygen.

KINGSTON
(catching his breath)
I'm okay. I'm okay.

Monique looks at Marc over her son's head. Her eyes say: he's not.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 11:47 AM

Marc and Harmony step out. Harmony leans against the wall.

HARMONY
His sats were eighty-eight on four liters.

MARC
I know.

HARMONY
Marc. He might not make it to tomorrow morning.

MARC
(quiet)
I know.

HARMONY
(beat)
You promised him.

MARC
I know, Harmony.

She looks at him: exhausted and stubborn, his heart all over his face. And she thinks about Peter Jennings. Four months.

HARMONY
(beat)
Marc, can I tell you something?

MARC
(distracted, looking at Kingston's door)
Mm-hm.

HARMONY
(taking a breath)
Ever since...

Esther comes around the corner carrying a camcorder bag. She sees them.

ESTHER
Marc, do you know how to work a MiniDV Handycam? The tape door is stuck, and my patient wants to record tonight.

MARC
(turning to Esther, lighting up)
Yeah, you have to hold the eject and push the little latch at the same time. Here.

He takes the camera from Esther and shows her. Their heads bend together over the little screen. Harmony watches them. The moment closes.

MARC
(turning back to Harmony)
Sorry. What were you going to say?

HARMONY
(beat, smiling, a little broken)
Nothing. It'll keep.

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC SURGERY - WAITING AREA - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 1:34 PM

Robert comes out in scrubs. Percival and Beatrice both stand. They're sitting on opposite sides of the room.

ROBERT
The surgery went well. Three bypass grafts. He's in the cardiac ICU. He'll be sedated and on a breathing tube overnight. If all goes well, we'll wake him tomorrow morning.

Percival closes his eyes in relief. Beatrice steps forward.

BEATRICE
I'm his sister. His legal next of kin. I want to be the one who's informed of every decision, and I want this man kept out of the ICU.

Percival stiffens. Robert's face doesn't change.

ROBERT
Mrs. Glover-Hollins. Mr. Glover listed Mr. Lane as his emergency contact. That's documented.

BEATRICE
An emergency contact is not next of kin. I called our family lawyer on the way here. Without a proxy, I'm the decision-maker.

ROBERT
(very evenly)
The hospital's attorney will clarify the details. In the meantime, ICU visitation is at the discretion of the unit, and the patient's documented wishes matter. (beat) Mr. Lane, you can see him now.

BEATRICE
(sharp)
Excuse me?

ROBERT
Ma'am, you may see him as well. One at a time. Mr. Lane was here first.

Percival walks past her toward the ICU doors with his head high. Beatrice watches him go, trembling with fury. Or with something else.

15 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEUROSURGERY - FAMILY ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 2:20 PM

A small room. Gabrielle sits on the couch in a blouse she changed into for this, her hair done. Esther sets the camcorder on a small tripod, frames the shot and presses RECORD. The red light comes on.

ESTHER
(behind the camera)
Whenever you're ready.

Gabrielle looks into the lens. Takes a deep breath.

GABRIELLE
(to the camera)
Hi, Jaylen. Hi, Simone. It's Mommy. (beat) If you're watching this, it's because you're older now, and I wanted to make sure you heard me say some things...

She falters. Stops.

GABRIELLE
(to Esther, voice cracking)
I can't. I don't know how to do this.

Esther stops recording. She comes around from behind the camera and sits next to Gabrielle.

ESTHER
Can I tell you something? (beat) When I was seven, my father was killed. In a robbery at his store. One minute he was there, and then he was gone. He didn't get to say anything to me. Not one word.

GABRIELLE
(quiet)
I'm so sorry.

ESTHER
(beat)
You know what I'd give to have a tape of him? Even just him saying "Good morning, baby girl" the way he did every day? Something stupid. Something small. (beat) It doesn't have to be a speech, Gabrielle. It just has to be you.

Gabrielle looks at her for a long moment. Then she nods. Esther goes back to the camera and presses RECORD.

GABRIELLE
(to the lens, smiling through tears)
Good morning, Jaylen. Good morning, Simone. Did you brush your teeth? Don't lie to me. I can tell when you're lying. You blink.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - OB/GYN CLINIC - ULTRASOUND ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 3:05 PM

Elxa on the table, rigid, scrub top pulled up. DR. HAMPTON (55), her OB from Jamaica Hospital, here as a professional courtesy, does the scan. Russell holds Elxa's hand.

DR. HAMPTON
This is the nuchal translucency measurement. The fluid at the back of the baby's neck. Thickened fluid can be associated with chromosomal conditions. (measuring) One point six millimeters. That's normal. Combined with your bloodwork, your risk is very low.

Elxa lets out a breath she's been holding since the elevator.

ELXA
(shakily)
Normal.

DR. HAMPTON
Normal. (smiling) Would you like to know the sex? It's early, but I can sometimes guess at thirteen weeks.

ELXA
(instantly)
No.

RUSSELL
(same moment)
Yes.

They look at each other.

ELXA
I want it to be the one thing in my life that isn't a lab value.

Russell looks at her. Then kisses her forehead.

RUSSELL
(to Dr. Hampton)
No, then.

ELXA
(beat, small)
Okay, tell Russell. Just not me. Write it on a card. Put it in an envelope. I'll find out in February like a normal person.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 5:48 PM

Kingston is sleeping now, breathing fast and shallow. His oxygen is up to six liters by face mask. Monique sits close, stroking his head. Crump stands at the foot of the bed, listening to his chest. Marc waits.

CRUMP
(quietly, straightening up)
Mrs. Wade. His lungs are filling. His liver is failing. I want you to be prepared for the possibility that it's tonight.

Monique doesn't cry. She's been preparing for six years.

MONIQUE
(very steady)
He wanted to see the landing.

CRUMP
I know.

MONIQUE
(to Marc)
You told him he would.

MARC
(quiet)
I did. I'm sorry.

MONIQUE
(shaking her head)
Don't be sorry. You gave him something to stay awake for. (beat) Six years of hospitals. Nobody's promised him anything in a long time.

Kingston stirs. Opens his eyes. Pulls the mask aside.

KINGSTON
(weak)
Dr. Bullock. Is it tomorrow yet?

MARC
(kneeling by the bed)
Not yet, man. Fourteen more hours.

KINGSTON
(eyes closing)
I wish I could talk to one of them. An astronaut. Just once. Ask them what it looks like.

He drifts off again. Marc kneels there a long moment. Then he stands.

MARC
(to Crump, quietly)
Excuse me. I have to make a phone call.

18 INT. PELL PAVILION - STAIRWELL C - DAY
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 6:02 PM

The concrete stairwell. Third step from the bottom, where Natasha sat. Marc sits down and dials his cell phone. It rings twice.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(on the phone, deep, warm, commanding)
Marc-Anthony.

MARC
(closing his eyes)
Hi, Grandpa.

VICTOR (V.O.)
Five weeks, and the first time you call me is a Monday at six o'clock. Something's wrong.

MARC
(beat)
I need a favor.

A long silence on the line. Then a low chuckle.

VICTOR (V.O.)
Twenty-six years, and you've never once asked me for anything. Not a car. Not a summer in Paris. Not a recommendation letter. You applied to Hopkins under your father's name without telling me. (beat) Tell me.

MARC
There's a ten-year-old boy. Neuroblastoma. Stage four. He's dying, Grandpa. Maybe tonight. He loves the space program more than anything in the world. Discovery lands tomorrow at eight-eleven. He wants to talk to an astronaut. Just once. To ask what it looks like.

A pause.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat)
NASA's chief medical officer sat on the Donohue Award committee in 1998. He owes me a dinner. (beat) And a retired astronaut sits on the board of our children's hospital in Houston. Bernard Ashe. He flew three shuttle missions.

MARC
(opening his eyes)
You can do that?

VICTOR (V.O.)
Marc-Anthony. I can do almost anything. That's the problem with me. (beat) What room?

MARC
Seven-fourteen. Queens Grace.

VICTOR (V.O.)
Give me two hours.

The line clicks off. Marc sits in the stairwell, staring at the phone. Then he puts his face in his hands.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

19 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 6:31 PM

Natasha at her desk, on the phone. Bernie Watkins has gone home. The skyline is turning orange.

NATASHA
(into the phone)
Daddy, you are not walking into my hospital.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(on the phone)
I'm not walking into your hospital, Tasha. I'm visiting a dying child.

NATASHA
Your face is on a poster in my residents' lounge. You'll be recognized in four seconds.

VICTOR (V.O.)
Then I'll come at dawn. And I'll use the back door.

Natasha closes her eyes.

NATASHA
(quiet)
He called you.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat)
For the first time in his life. (beat) For someone else.

A long silence. Natasha looks out at the city.

NATASHA
(softening)
Big Ray Toles. Chief of Security. I'll call him. Loading dock on Thomson Avenue. Five a.m.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(amused)
A loading dock.

NATASHA
(beat, realizing)
Daddy. I didn't mean...

VICTOR (V.O.)
(quietly)
I know you didn't, baby. It's fitting. (beat) I'll see you in the morning.

20 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 4 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 7:15 PM

Teddy lies sedated and intubated, chest bandaged, monitors steady. Percival sits beside him, holding his hand. Beatrice stands in the doorway, unwilling to come closer.

PERCIVAL
(not looking at her)
You can come in, Bea. He won't bite. He's unconscious.

Beatrice steps in. Stiffly. She looks at her brother: the tubes, the machines.

BEATRICE
(quiet)
He looks old.

PERCIVAL
He is old. We both are. (beat) You haven't seen him since 1974.

BEATRICE
(sharp)
Because of you.

PERCIVAL
(calm)
Because you told him at your mother's funeral, in front of the whole church, that he was going to hell, and that if he brought "that man" to Thanksgiving, you'd never speak to him again. (beat) And then you didn't. For thirty-one years.

Beatrice's face cracks, just slightly.

BEATRICE
(beat)
I sent him a Christmas card.
Every year.

PERCIVAL
(beat)
I know. He kept every one.
They're in a shoebox in our hall
closet. Thirty-one cards. He
reads them every December, and
every December he cries.

Beatrice puts a hand on the bed rail. She can't speak.

21 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - NURSES' STATION - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 7:40 PM

Amond at the station with Franklin Bassett (46), hospital General Counsel, who's reading the chart. Raven is there with a box of crackers from the vending machine.

BASSETT
(reading)
No health care proxy. No living
will. Emergency contact: Lane.
(beat) Dr. Baker, I know how you
feel. I feel it too. But if Mr.
Glover doesn't regain capacity,
in practice the hospital will
turn to the sister for major
decisions. That's how New York
does it right now.

AMOND
And if he does regain capacity?

BASSETT
Then he can sign a proxy on the
spot. Any competent adult can
name anyone as their health care
agent. It's a one-page form. Two
adult witnesses. Neither can be
the agent.

AMOND
(beat)
How competent does he need to be?

BASSETT
Awake. Oriented. Able to understand what he's signing and what it means. A doctor has to attest to it.

AMOND
Robert's planning to extubate him in the morning.

BASSETT
Then in the morning, if he's lucid, he can sign. (beat) If something happens tonight...

AMOND
(beat)
Then nothing happens tonight.

Raven, eavesdropping, looks up from her crackers.

RAVEN
You need two witnesses?

AMOND
Not the agent. Not his doctor.

RAVEN
(raising her hand)
I'm not his doctor. (beat) And Gloria's working tonight. She's witnessed probably ten thousand things.

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 8:16 PM

The room phone rings. Monique, dozing, answers.

MONIQUE
(groggy)
Hello?

She listens. Her eyes go wide. She turns to Marc, who's been sitting in the corner.

MONIQUE
(stunned, covering the receiver)
It's... he says he's an astronaut.

Marc stands up. Kingston, half asleep, hears the word. His eyes snap open.

KINGSTON
(weak, reaching)
Mom. Mom. Give it to me.

Monique puts the phone on speaker and holds it beside his pillow.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
(on the phone, warm, gravelly)
Is this Kingston Wade? Commander of Room Seven-Fourteen?

KINGSTON
(breathless)
Yes. Yes, sir.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
Kingston, my name is Colonel Bernard Ashe, retired. I flew on Atlantis in 1992, Discovery in 1995, and Endeavour in 1998. I hear you're the biggest shuttle fan in the state of New York.

KINGSTON
(crying, laughing, struggling for air)
You flew Discovery.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
I did, son. She's a good ship. She's coming home tomorrow. (beat) Somebody told me you have a question.

Kingston can barely breathe. He pulls the oxygen mask aside.

KINGSTON
(whispering)
What does it look like? The Earth? From up there?

A pause on the line.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
(gently)
Kingston, it looks like the most beautiful thing you've ever seen. A big blue marble with white clouds wrapped around it like cotton, and the edge of it glows. There's a thin line of blue on the curve, the atmosphere, and it's so thin you can't believe it's holding everything in. And at night, the cities light up like somebody spilled gold dust all over the ground. You can see New York from up there. I've seen it.

KINGSTON
(eyes closed, smiling)
You saw New York.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
I saw your whole city glowing, son. And the funny thing is, from up there, you can't see any borders. No lines. Just one planet, all of us on it together.

Monique has her hand over her mouth. Marc stands by the door. He doesn't trust himself to move.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
Kingston, I'll be watching the landing tomorrow from Houston. Will you watch it with me? We'll call it together.

KINGSTON
(barely audible)
Yes, sir.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
Then you rest up, Commander. Eight-eleven a.m. Eastern. That's an order.

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 8:41 PM

Marc steps out into the hallway and leans against the wall, shaking. Elxa is standing there. She's been there a while.

ELXA
(quietly)
An astronaut.

MARC
(wiping his face)
Colonel Bernard Ashe. Three shuttle missions.

ELXA
(beat)
You called Grandpa.

MARC
(quiet)
I called Grandpa.

ELXA
For a patient.

MARC
He's ten, Elxa.

Elxa looks at him for a long moment. Then she pulls her baby brother into a hug, right there in the hallway, fast and fierce.

ELXA
(into his shoulder)
That's the most Donohue thing you've ever done. (beat) It's also the most you thing you've ever done.

24 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEUROSURGERY - FAMILY ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 9:30 PM

Five MiniDV tapes, labeled in Sharpie, sit on the coffee table: "JAYLEN - 16TH BIRTHDAY." "SIMONE - FIRST DAY OF HIGH SCHOOL." "BOTH - GRADUATION." "JAYLEN - WEDDING DAY." "SIMONE - WEDDING DAY." Gabrielle is wiped out. Esther packs up the tripod.

GABRIELLE
(exhausted)
Five tapes. Three hours. I talked about everything. Boys, girls, money, God, why they shouldn't get tattoos until they're twenty-five.

ESTHER
(smiling)
You were great.

GABRIELLE
(beat)
Can I ask you something personal, Dr. Smilley? (Esther nods) Who's the tape for? For you. The one you'd make.

Esther stops packing. She sits down slowly.

ESTHER
(quiet)
I don't know.

GABRIELLE
(gently)
I don't believe that.

Esther looks at her hands. Her fingers drift to the chain at her collarbone.

ESTHER
(beat)
There's someone in my life I haven't been honest with. About where I've been. About who I was before I came here. (beat) And there's someone else I haven't been honest with about... how I feel. (beat) If tomorrow never came, I'd want to tell them both the truth.

GABRIELLE
(beat)
Then why haven't you?

ESTHER
(almost laughing)
Because tomorrow always comes. And I'm a coward.

GABRIELLE
(shaking her head)
No, you're not. You sat with me for three hours while I told my babies goodbye. That's not a coward. (beat) That's someone who knows exactly how much it matters.

25 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - FAMILY LOUNGE - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 10:08 PM

A small lounge with a coffee machine. Percival sits with a paper cup, his three-piece suit finally rumpled. Amond comes in for coffee, sees him and hesitates. Then sits down across from him.

PERCIVAL
You stood up for me this morning. In the code. When the nurse tried to put me out.

AMOND
(uncomfortable)
It was obvious.

PERCIVAL
It hasn't been obvious to most people for most of my life, Dr. Baker. (beat) May I tell you something?

Amond nods.

PERCIVAL
I met Teddy in 1963, at a club on 125th Street called the Shalimar. He was playing piano. Bad piano. He was a music teacher who thought he was Thelonious Monk. (smiling) I was a bank teller who thought I was nobody. He played "'Round Midnight" four times that night and looked at me every time.

AMOND
(beat)
1963.

PERCIVAL
It was illegal to be what we were in 1963. We could have been arrested for dancing together. In 1969 we were two blocks from the Stonewall when it started, and Teddy pulled me into a doorway because he was afraid I'd get my teeth knocked out. (beat) In the eighties we went to forty-one funerals. Forty-one. Friends. The plague took a whole world. And somehow it left us.

Amond is very still.

PERCIVAL
Forty-two years, and today a nurse told me I wasn't family because we never filled out a piece of paper. (beat) We never filled it out, Doctor, because filling it out meant admitting one of us would someday be in a bed like that. And we didn't want to look at it.

AMOND
(quietly)
He'll sign it. Tomorrow. When he's off the tube. I'll make sure.

PERCIVAL
(looking at him)
Why does it matter so much to you?

Amond looks at his coffee.

AMOND
(beat)
Because I was nine when my father died, and nobody asked me anything. Not what I wanted. Not if I wanted to say goodbye. They just decided. (beat) Nobody should get decided about.

26 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 4 - NIGHT
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 11:52 PM

Teddy is awake. Early. His sedation is light now, the breathing tube still in, his eyes open and frightened. Percival is beside him. Beatrice is asleep in a chair. Amond checks Teddy's pupils and reflexes. Then the monitor alarms. Teddy's heart rate jumps to 160, irregular.

AMOND
(urgently)
A-fib with RVR. (to the nurse) Amiodarone bolus. Call Dr. Bullock.

Teddy's eyes roll. His pressure is dropping. Percival grips his hand.

PERCIVAL
Teddy! Teddy, stay with me!

Beatrice wakes with a start. She sees her brother: the alarms, the pressure falling. She stands.

BEATRICE
(frightened)
What's happening? What's happening to him?

AMOND
His heart's in an abnormal rhythm. We're treating it.

The pressure hits 70/40. Teddy's eyes go unfocused. The nurse pushes the amiodarone. Nothing yet. Amond grabs the defibrillator paddles.

AMOND
Prepare to cardiovert. One-twenty joules, synchronized.

Teddy's hand slips out of Percival's. Beatrice stares at the monitor.

BEATRICE
(whispering)
Teddy.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

27 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 4 - CONTINUOUS
MONDAY, AUGUST 8, 2005 - 11:53 PM

Amond presses the paddles to Teddy's chest.

AMOND
Clear.

Everyone steps back. THUMP. Teddy's body jolts. On the monitor, the wild rhythm stutters... and snaps back to a steady sinus rhythm. Ninety-two beats a minute. The pressure climbs: 88... 98... 110.

NURSE
Sinus. Pressure's coming up.

Teddy's eyes refocus. He blinks around the tube. Finds Percival. Percival grabs his hand again.

PERCIVAL
(crying)
There you are. There you are, you old fool.

Then Teddy's eyes move past Percival, to the other side of the bed, where Beatrice is standing frozen, her hands over her mouth. He stares at her. He hasn't seen her in thirty-one years. His eyes fill.

Slowly, Beatrice reaches out and takes her brother's other hand.

BEATRICE
(shaking)
Hello, Teddy.

Teddy squeezes. Hard. Amond steps back, quietly, to the foot of the bed. Robert arrives at the door, takes in the scene, and stops.

ROBERT
(low, to Amond)
You cardioverted?

AMOND
He didn't have time to wait.

ROBERT
(beat, nodding)
Correct.

28 INT. PELL PAVILION - STAIRWELL B - NIGHT
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 12:41 AM

Arianna on her cell phone in the stairwell. Kendra sits two steps above her.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
...the bus station. She was at the Greyhound station. (listening, closing her eyes) She was trying to buy a ticket to Chicago with six dollars and a library card. (beat) No, I'm not laughing. I'm not laughing, Aaliyah. (beat) Methodist. Okay. Okay. The psych unit. (beat) Is she... did she ask for me?

A long pause. Arianna's face does something painful.

ARIANNA
(quiet)
She thinks I'm still fourteen. (beat) Yeah. Tell her I said hi. Tell her I'm in New York being a doctor. (beat) No, she won't remember. Tell her anyway.

She hangs up. Sits there. Kendra comes down one step and sits beside her.

KENDRA
She's okay?

ARIANNA
She's alive. She's on a psych hold. She asked my sister when I was getting home from school. (beat) I've been gone eleven years.

Kendra doesn't say anything. She puts her head on Arianna's shoulder. Arianna lets her.

ARIANNA
(very quiet)
Every time the phone rings from Gary, I think, this is the call. The one where she's dead. And every time she's not, I'm so relieved I want to throw up. And then I hate her for making me feel it.

KENDRA
That's not hate, Gary.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I know.

29 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE ROOF - NIGHT
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 1:30 AM

Harmony sits on the roof with a notepad on her knee. She's written two lines. She looks at them for a long time. Raven comes up the stairwell with two coffees.

RAVEN
You disappeared.

HARMONY
(folding the notepad)
I needed air.

RAVEN
(sitting, handing her a coffee)
What's that?

HARMONY
(beat)
A letter. To Marc. (beat) "Dear Marc. I've been in love with you since the day you let me move into your house." (beat) That's as far as I got.

RAVEN
(softly)
That's pretty far.

HARMONY
(looking out at the skyline)
Peter Jennings had four months. Kingston has hours. Mr. Glover almost had none. And I've been sitting on this for six weeks, thinking, if tomorrow never comes, he'll never know.

RAVEN
So tell him.

HARMONY
(beat)
And then what? He looks at me with those big sad eyes and says, "Harmony, you're amazing, you're my friend," and then I still live in his house. And I see him every morning in the kitchen. (beat) If tomorrow never comes, at least I didn't wreck today.

She tears the page out of the notepad, folds it very small and puts it in her pocket. Not the trash. Her pocket.

RAVEN
(watching)
You kept it.

HARMONY
(beat)
In case tomorrow comes.

30 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE 714 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 2:22 AM

Marc stands in the doorway of 714, watching Kingston breathe. Esther comes down the dark corridor with two cups of coffee. She hands him one.

ESTHER
(whispering)
Harmony said you haven't left.

MARC
(whispering)
I told him I'd wake him up.

They stand side by side in the doorway, watching the boy and his mother sleep. The NASA TV glow flickers blue

across the room.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Gabrielle recorded five tapes. For her kids. Birthdays, graduations, weddings. In case.

MARC
(beat)
That's the bravest thing I've ever heard.

ESTHER
(looking at him)
She asked me who my tape would be for.

Marc turns to look at her. The blue light on her face.

MARC
(softly)
Who would it be for?

Esther opens her mouth. Her hand goes to the chain at her collarbone. The moment is right there.

Inside the room, Kingston coughs: a long, wet, terrible cough. Monique stirs. Marc is moving toward the bed before the cough is over.

Esther watches him go: kneeling by the boy, his big hand on the small bald head, murmuring. She closes her mouth. Sets her coffee on the windowsill outside the door, for later. And quietly leaves.

31 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 3:14 AM

Kingston's breathing is labored: long pauses, then gasps. Monique lies in the bed beside him, her arm around him. Marc sits in the chair, awake, watching the monitor. Oxygen saturation: 84%. The countdown on the window: TUESDAY, AUGUST 9.

KINGSTON
(eyes closed, barely audible)
Dr. Bullock?

MARC
I'm here, man.

KINGSTON
What time is it?

MARC
Three-fourteen. Five hours to go.

KINGSTON
(beat)
That's not that long.

MARC
(quiet)
It's nothing. It's a nap.

KINGSTON
(beat)
Will you wake me up? If I'm asleep?

MARC
(beat)
I'll wake you up.

Monique looks at Marc over her son's head. Her eyes are full. Marc nods: I've got him. She closes her eyes.

32 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LOADING DOCK - THOMSON AVENUE - DAWN
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 4:48 AM

Pre-dawn. The hospital's loading dock, behind the Pell Pavilion. A black Lincoln Town Car pulls up. The rear door opens. A tall, silver-bearded man in a three-piece suit, holding a gold pocket watch, steps out onto the loading dock: DR. VICTOR DONOHUE (72).

He stands on the concrete for a moment, looking at the dock. Something passes across his face. Mississippi, 1958. A loading dock. A boy named Elijah.

The service door opens. Big Ray Toles (45) stands there in his security uniform. He's been told. He's never been this nervous in his life.

BIG RAY
(barely audible)
Dr. Donohue.

VICTOR
(extending a hand)
Mr. Toles. My daughter tells me you're the most discreet man in Queens.

BIG RAY
(shaking it, awed)
Yes, sir. The service elevator's ready, sir. Straight to seven.

VICTOR
(stepping through the door)
Thank you. (beat) I've always preferred coming in through the back. Old habit.

33 INT. PELL PAVILION - 7TH FLOOR - ELEVATOR LOBBY - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 4:56 AM

The service elevator opens on the seventh floor. Big Ray steps out first, checks the hallway, and nods. Victor steps out.

At that exact moment, Arianna comes around the corner with a chart, heading for the stairwell. She stops dead.

She knows that face. Every surgeon in America knows that face. The portrait is in every hospital lobby that has ever taken Donohue money. There's a poster of him in the residents' lounge, for the Donohue Award.

Victor nods at her politely, the way a grandfather nods at a stranger. Then he walks down the hall toward Room 714, Big Ray at his side.

Arianna watches him go. Watches him stop at Kingston's door, the room assigned to Marc-Anthony Bullock. Watches the door open and Marc come out, take one look at the old man, and say something that makes his whole face crumple.

Watches Victor Donohue pull Marc-Anthony Bullock into a hug.

Arianna stands frozen in the elevator lobby. Then, very slowly, she lets out a breath.

ARIANNA
(whispering)
"Common name."

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

34 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 4 - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 5:40 AM

Dawn through the ICU window. Teddy, freshly extubated, propped up, hoarse but lucid. Percival on one side, Beatrice on the other. Amond stands with a clipboard. Raven and Gloria Pettiford are at the foot of the bed. Bassett is in the doorway.

AMOND
Mr. Glover. Can you tell me your name?

TEDDY
(hoarse)
Theodore Augustus Glover.

AMOND
Where are you?

TEDDY
Queens Grace. Tuesday, August ninth. The shuttle lands today. (beat) A nice boy on the seventh floor told the whole ICU at midnight.

AMOND
(beat)
Do you understand what a health care proxy is?

TEDDY
It means if I lose my marbles, someone I trust decides what to do with them.

AMOND
Who do you want that to be?

Teddy turns his head. Looks at Percival.

TEDDY
(hoarse, firm)
Percival Lane. My partner. For forty-two years.

Percival covers his mouth with his hand.

AMOND
And an alternate? If Mr. Lane can't serve?

Teddy turns his head slowly to the other side. Looks at his sister.

TEDDY
(beat)
Beatrice Glover-Hollins. My sister.

Beatrice's composure breaks completely. She sobs, once. Teddy squeezes her hand.

AMOND
(handing him the pen and the clipboard)
Sign here, Mr. Glover. (to Raven and Gloria) Witnesses.

Teddy signs. His hand shakes, but the signature is his. Raven signs as a witness. Gloria signs as a witness. Amond signs the attestation of capacity.

GLORIA
(handing the form to Bassett)
Thirty years, I've witnessed a lot of things. That's one of the good ones.

BASSETT
(reading it, nodding)
It's valid. As of five forty-four a.m.

Percival takes Teddy's hand and kisses his knuckles. Beatrice holds the other hand. Amond steps back and watches. Then, quietly, he walks out.

35 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 5:47 AM

Amond leans against the wall outside the ICU, eyes closed. Robert finds him there.

ROBERT
Bassett says it's signed.

AMOND
Partner as agent. Sister as alternate.

ROBERT
(beat, impressed)
The sister.

AMOND
He forgave her. Just like that. Thirty-one years of Christmas cards, and he forgave her in one second. (beat) I don't understand how people do that.

ROBERT
(beat)
They decide tomorrow isn't promised. And they'd rather not spend it angry. (beat) You told me once you've never visited your father's grave.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm calling my mother this weekend. Like you said. (beat) I'm going to ask her where he's buried. I don't even know the plot number.

36 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 8:04 AM

The room is full but silent. NASA TV fills the screen: a long shot of the Mojave Desert at sunrise, the runway at Edwards Air Force Base, waiting. Kingston is propped up on pillows, his oxygen mask on, barely conscious, but his eyes are open, fixed on the screen. Monique holds him.

Victor Donohue sits in a chair by the bed, introduced to Monique as "Dr. Donohue, a friend of the hospital." Marc kneels by Kingston's head. Crump stands at the foot of the bed in his black bow tie. Harmony and Elxa are in the doorway. The speakerphone sits on the pillow: Colonel Ashe is on the line from Houston.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
(on the speaker)
Kingston. You with me, Commander?

KINGSTON
(barely audible, behind the mask)
Yes, sir.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
She's crossing over the Pacific now. Coming in at Mach 2. You're going to hear two sonic booms right before she lands. Boom, boom. That's how you know she's home.

ON THE TV: NASA TV. A white dot in the brightening sky. Then the Space Shuttle Discovery, nose up, gliding down toward the desert runway in total silence. The NASA COMMENTATOR (V.O.) speaks.

NASA COMMENTATOR (V.O.)
(on TV)
...Discovery on final approach, runway two-two at Edwards Air Force Base...

Through the TV speakers: BOOM-BOOM. The double sonic boom. Kingston's eyes go wide behind the mask.

KINGSTON
(whispering)
Boom, boom.

VICTOR
(softly, leaning in)
That's her, son. She's home.

ON THE TV: The main gear touches down on the desert runway in a puff of dust. Then the nose gear. The drag chute blooms out behind the shuttle, white against the sky.

NASA COMMENTATOR (V.O.)
(on TV)
...main gear touchdown... nose gear touchdown... and Discovery is home, completing its Return to Flight mission...

The orbiter rolls down the runway, slowing, slowing, and stops.

COL. ASHE (V.O.)
(on the speaker, his voice catching)
Wheels stop, Commander. Wheels stop.

Kingston pulls the mask down with a trembling hand. He's smiling. The biggest smile any of them have ever seen.

KINGSTON
(barely a breath)
Wheels stop.

Monique kisses his bald head. Harmony, in the doorway, is crying silently. Elxa puts an arm around her.

KINGSTON
(eyes drifting, to Marc)
You said I'd see it.

MARC
(kneeling, crying)
You saw it, man.

KINGSTON
(whispering)
You didn't lie.

His eyes close. He's still smiling.

37 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - ROOM 714 - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 9:42 AM

The room is quiet now. NASA TV is still on, muted, showing the crew walking around the orbiter on the runway. Kingston lies in his mother's arms, peaceful. The monitor has been turned off.

Crump puts his stethoscope to Kingston's chest. Listens. Takes it away. He looks at his watch.

CRUMP
(very gently)
Time of death, nine forty-two a.m.

Monique holds her son and rocks him. She doesn't wail. She hums: a lullaby, low and steady.

Marc stands by the window, by the countdown sign. TUESDAY, AUGUST 9. He reaches up and peels it off the glass, folds

it carefully, and holds it.

Victor rises from the chair. He puts a hand on Monique's shoulder. She looks up at him.

MONIQUE
(barely audible)
Thank you. For the astronaut.

VICTOR
(gently)
Your son was a very brave young man, Mrs. Wade.

He looks over at Marc by the window. Their eyes meet. Then Victor leaves the room quietly.

38 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEURO-INTERVENTIONAL SUITE - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 10:10 AM

Gabrielle, post-embolization, awake and groggy on a stretcher, a pressure dressing on her groin. Graves reviews the angiogram: the AVM is mostly dark now, its feeding vessels glued shut. Esther stands beside the stretcher holding a plastic bag with five MiniDV tapes.

GRAVES
Ninety percent of the feeders are embolized. Surgery tomorrow should be straightforward. Relatively speaking.

GABRIELLE
(groggy)
Relatively.

Esther sets the tapes in Gabrielle's lap.

ESTHER
Your tapes.

GABRIELLE
(holding them)
Keep them. Until after tomorrow. In case.

ESTHER
(shaking her head)
No. You keep them. And on Jaylen's sixteenth birthday, you're going to give him that tape yourself, and you're going to sit next to him while he watches it, and you're going to be embarrassed about what you said about tattoos.

Gabrielle laughs weakly. She holds the tapes to her chest.

39 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY - CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 9:51 AM

Marc stands in the hallway outside 714, the folded countdown sign in his hand. Dr. Crump comes out of the room and stands beside him. For a long moment neither speaks.

CRUMP
(quietly)
You know why I wore black today?

MARC
(looking at the bow tie)
I figured.

CRUMP
Thirty-five years. I've worn a black tie on every day I knew I'd lose one. Four hundred and some days. I stopped counting in 1988. (beat) My wife says the drawer of black ties is the saddest drawer in Queens.

He reaches up and slowly undoes the bow tie. He holds it out.

CRUMP
You keep this one.

MARC
(stunned)
Dr. Crump, I can't...

CRUMP
You made a ten-year-old a promise you had no right to make, and then you moved heaven and earth, or whoever you called, to keep it. (beat) Pediatric surgery is mostly losing, son. If you're going to do this for the rest of your life, you'll need a black tie. Better to get your first one from somebody who knows what it weighs.

Marc takes the bow tie. Holds it with the countdown sign.

MARC
(barely audible)
Thank you.

CRUMP
(patting his shoulder, walking away)
Don't thank me. Learn to tie it. Clip-ons are for cowards.

40 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 10:02 AM

Natasha stands at her window. The door opens: Big Ray, then Victor. Big Ray withdraws and closes the door. Father and daughter, alone in the Chief's office.

VICTOR
(looking around)
You moved the desk.

NATASHA
In 1999. You haven't been in this office since I became Chief.

VICTOR
You haven't invited me.

NATASHA
(beat)
The boy?

VICTOR
(quietly)
Nine forty-two. He saw it land. He smiled. (beat) Our grandson was magnificent, Tasha. He knelt by that bed for six hours.

Natasha's eyes fill. She turns back to the window.

VICTOR
(gently)
Sylvia Rountree sends me your budget every quarter. Did you know that? She thinks I'll take pity.

NATASHA
(not turning)
Don't.

VICTOR
Forty-four million. It's a rounding error, baby. It's what the Foundation spends on paper clips.

NATASHA
(turning, fierce)
And the day I take it, every surgeon in this building becomes your surgeon. Every patient becomes your press release. Your grandson becomes the Donohue heir who works at the Donohue charity hospital. (beat) Not yet, Daddy. Maybe not ever. Let me do this one thing without your name on it.

Victor looks at his daughter for a long time: the only one of his four children who ever told him no.

VICTOR
(beat, quiet)
You came in through the front door your whole life, Natasha. I came in through the back. (beat) Maybe that's the difference between us.

NATASHA
(softly)
Or maybe it's the thing you gave me.

Victor smiles: the rare, real one. He crosses and kisses her forehead.

VICTOR
Walk me to the loading dock.

NATASHA
(beat)
Marc will walk you. I can't be seen with you, Daddy. Not in this building. (beat, small smile) It's a big family.

41 EXT. PELL PAVILION - LOADING DOCK - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 10:31 AM

The Town Car idles at the loading dock. Marc walks Victor out through the service door, still in scrubs, still holding the folded countdown sign. Big Ray stands guard at a respectful distance.

Up in a third-floor window of the Pell Pavilion, unseen by either of them, Arianna watches.

VICTOR
You didn't sleep.

MARC
Neither did you.

VICTOR
I'm seventy-two. I don't sleep anyway. (beat) You stayed with him all night.

MARC
I told him I'd wake him up.

Victor looks at the loading dock beneath their feet. The concrete. The Thomson Avenue traffic.

VICTOR
Forty-seven years ago, I operated on a boy on a loading dock in Mississippi because they wouldn't let him through the front door. (beat) This morning I came in through the back door of your hospital so nobody would know I was your grandfather. (beat, wry) That's progress, I suppose.

MARC
(quiet)
Grandpa, I'm sorry. I know you hate this. The hiding.

VICTOR
(beat)
I don't hate it. I don't understand it. That's different. (beat) But last night you asked me for something for the first time in your life. And it wasn't for you. It was for a ten-year-old boy you met three weeks ago.

He puts his big hand on Marc's shoulder.

VICTOR
(low)
You know what's in the letter, Marc-Anthony. You've known since you were twenty-one.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

VICTOR
(quiet, absolute)
Then know this too. If tomorrow never comes for me, and someday it won't, I want you to remember that I chose right.

Marc can't speak. Victor squeezes his shoulder, gets into the Town Car, and the door closes. The car pulls out onto Thomson Avenue and is gone.

Above, in the third-floor window, Arianna lets the blind fall back into place.

TAG

42 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 12:15 PM

Post-call. Marc sits at the kitchen table, staring at the folded countdown sign in front of him. Harmony comes in, sets a cup of tea in front of him without a word, and sits down across from him.

HARMONY
(quietly)
He smiled. At the end.

MARC
(not looking up)
He said, "You didn't lie."

HARMONY
You didn't.

A long silence. Marc unfolds the sign and smooths it on the table: TUESDAY, AUGUST 9.

MARC
(beat)
I'm going to frame it. Put it in the hallway.

HARMONY
(softly)
That's a good idea.

She reaches across the table and puts her hand over his. Marc squeezes it, grateful. The way you squeeze a friend's hand. Harmony feels the folded letter in her pocket. She doesn't take it out.

MARC (V.O.)
We spend so much of our lives acting like tomorrow's guaranteed. That there'll always be time to say it, fix it, make the call, sign the paper, forgive the sister.

MARC (V.O.)
And most days, we're right. Tomorrow comes.

43 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - THE SAILBOAT "CLARENCE" - DAY
TUESDAY, AUGUST 9, 2005 - 1:02 PM

Esther sits in the boat's small cabin with a borrowed MiniDV Handycam on a stack of books, aimed at her face. She presses RECORD. The red light comes on.

ESTHER
(to the camera)
Marc. (beat) If you're watching this, it means I didn't have the nerve to tell you myself. There's something you need to know about me. About Boston. About why I...

She stops. Looks at the red light for a long moment. Then she reaches over and presses STOP. Ejects the tape. Holds it in her hand.

MARC (V.O.)
But not always.

She puts the tape in a drawer, beside the folded Luxe Noir photocopy, and closes it.

MARC (V.O.)
So say it. Before tomorrow.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x06

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: "GOODNIGHT, PETER"

Monday, August 8, 2005

"Peter Jennings, the urbane, Canadian-born anchor of ABC's World News Tonight for 22 years, died yesterday at his Manhattan home of lung cancer. He was 67. Jennings had announced his diagnosis on the air in April. On Sept. 11, 2001, he anchored for more than 60 hours over the following days, becoming for many Americans the steady voice of the worst days in the city's history..."

CaringBridge: "Kingston's Mission Log" (journal by Monique Wade)

Monday, August 8, 2005, 11:58 PM

"Friends. Tonight a real astronaut called Room 714. Colonel Bernard Ashe, who flew Discovery in 1995. He told Kingston what the Earth looks like from space. Kingston hasn't smiled like that since he was six. His doctors say it may not be long now. He wants to see the landing at 8:11 tomorrow morning. Please pray he gets to. Please pray for us. -- Mom" (Guestbook: 212 entries)

nasa.gov: STS-114 Mission Update

Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 8:15 AM EDT

"Space Shuttle Discovery landed at 8:11:22 a.m. EDT (5:11:22 a.m. PDT) on Runway 22 at Edwards Air Force Base, Calif., completing the 14-day Return to Flight mission. Florida weather prevented a landing at Kennedy Space Center."

CaringBridge: "Kingston's Mission Log"

Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 1:40 PM

"Kingston Michael Wade, March 21, 1995 - August 9, 2005. My son saw Discovery land at 8:11 this morning. Two sonic booms. He heard them. He said 'wheels stop' with the astronaut. At 9:42 he went home too. His doctor stayed with him all night and kept his promise. Thank you, Queens Grace. Thank you, Dr. B. Wheels stop, baby. -- Mom" (Guestbook: 640 entries)

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Arianna Cummings and Kendra Wallace)

Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 10:36 AM

Arianna: "u ever find out something HUGE about somebody and decide to keep it to yourself"

Kendra: "every day gary. i work in a hospital"

Arianna: "like REALLY huge"

Kendra: "then keep it. ppl tell u when they're ready"

Arianna: "...ok"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 11:20 PM

"No gossip tonight. Room 714 lost its commander this morning, right after Discovery came home. Somebody got an actual astronaut on the phone for him last night. Nobody will say who arranged it. (Rumor: a VIP came in through the LOADING DOCK at dawn. Big Ray won't confirm, deny or make eye contact.) Wheels stop, Kingston." Comments (96).

AIM: away message, AortaOrBust79 (Amond Baker)

Tuesday, August 9, 2005, 6:45 PM

"Calling my mother. Do not disturb. Seriously."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x06

New Canon Established

- **Kingston Wade** (10), stage IV neuroblastoma, died at 9:42 AM on Tuesday, August 9, 2005, about 90 minutes after watching Discovery land (8:11 AM EDT). Marc kept his promise. He framed the window countdown ('TUESDAY, AUGUST 9') for the hallway of the House on 49th Avenue. This is Marc's second death at QGH.
- **Victor Donohue's first on-screen appearance:** he entered through the QGH loading dock (Thomson Avenue) at 4:48 AM on August 9, escorted by Big Ray. He arranged the call with retired astronaut Col. Bernard Ashe (a Donohue children's hospital board member in Houston) through his network. He was introduced to Monique as 'Dr. Donohue, a friend of the hospital.'
- **Marc has known he is Victor's heir since age 21** ('You know what's in the letter'). Victor: 'If tomorrow never comes for me... remember that I chose right.' First time Marc has asked his grandfather for anything.
- **Arianna knows.** She saw Victor hug Marc outside Room 714 (4:56 AM) and watched them at the loading dock (10:31 AM). She has said nothing and intends to keep it ('then keep it. ppl tell u when they're ready').
- **Big Ray knows** (he escorted Victor).
- **Teddy Glover's health care proxy** (5:44 AM, August 9): agent Percival Lane, alternate Beatrice Glover-Hollins. Witnesses: Raven Ellison and Gloria Pettiford; Amond attested to capacity. Teddy and Beatrice reconciled after 31 years.
- **Harmony's unsent letter to Marc** ('Dear Marc. I've been in love with you since the day you let me move into your house.') is folded in her pocket. 'In case tomorrow comes.'
- **Esther recorded, then stopped, a MiniDV tape** addressed to Marc about 'Boston.' The tape is in a drawer on the Clarence, next to the Luxe Noir photocopy. She told Gabrielle Foster there are two people she hasn't been honest with.
- **Elxa's nuchal translucency** is 1.6 mm (normal), with low risk. Russell knows the baby's sex in a sealed card; Elxa doesn't want to know until February.
- **Arianna's mother, Loretta,** went missing for two days, was found at the Gary Greyhound station and is on a psych hold at Methodist. She thinks Arianna is still 14.
- **Amond** will ask his mother where his father is buried. He told Percival: 'Nobody should get decided about.' **Percival and Teddy** met in 1963 at the Shalimar on 125th Street; they were near Stonewall in 1969 and went to 41 AIDS-era funerals. **Natasha refused Victor's money again** in her office (10:02 AM): 'Let me do this one thing without your name on it.' **Crump gave Marc his black bow tie** (9:51 AM): 'Pediatric surgery is mostly losing.' **Raven called her grandmother** to say 'I love you.' **Esther nearly told Marc** at 2:22 AM, and left her coffee on the windowsill.

Knowledge Tracker: Marc's True Identity (as of August 9, 2005)

Knows	Suspects / partial	Doesn't know
Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna (saw it; Marc doesn't know she knows)	Esther (promised 'later'), Crump	Raven, Harmony (met 'Dr. Donohue' without making the connection), Monique Wade, Monty, Celia and others; Julian Whitmore (C-073)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Kingston Wade	3/21/1995 (10)	Relapsed stage IV neuroblastoma	Comfort care (Crump; Marc)	Died 9:42 AM, 8/9/2005
Theodore Glover	2/2/1937 (68)	Three-vessel CAD with left main; acute anterior MI; post-op A-fib with RVR	Emergent CABG x3 (Robert; Amond); synchronized cardioversion (Amond)	Extubated, lucid, proxy signed
Gabrielle Foster	12/9/1970 (34)	Left motor cortex AVM, bled July 2005	Embolization 8/9 (Graves); resection scheduled 8/10	Recorded 5 MiniDV tapes for her children
Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (27)	Pregnancy, 13 weeks	NT scan (Dr. Hampton)	Normal (1.6 mm)

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Kingston Wade** (1995-2005) and **Monique Wade** (b. July 14, 1972).
- **Theodore 'Teddy' Glover** (b. February 2, 1937), a retired Juilliard music teacher; **Percival Lane** (b. June 12, 1935), his partner since 1963; **Beatrice Glover-Hollins** (b. March 3, 1941), Teddy's sister.
- **Gabrielle Foster** (b. December 9, 1970), an LIRR conductor, with children Jaylen (8) and Simone (5).
- **Mother Odetta Banks** (b. January 30, 1914), a 91-year-old church mother who told Raven to call her grandmother. **Dr. Hampton** (b. April 20, 1950), Elxa's OB at Jamaica Hospital. **Col. Bernard Ashe, USAF (Ret.)** (b. October 1, 1946), a *fictional* astronaut (STS flights in 1992, 1995, 1998 in this world) and Donohue children's hospital board member in Houston.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Peter Jennings died August 7, 2005, at 67, four months after announcing lung cancer in April 2005. STS-114 Discovery landed at Edwards AFB, Runway 22, at 8:11:22 AM EDT on August 9, 2005, after Florida weather waved off the KSC landing; double sonic booms and the drag chute are accurate. Stephen Robinson's August 3 spacewalk removed the protruding gap fillers.
- New York in 2005: any competent adult can appoint a health care agent (Public Health Law Art. 29-C, 1990) with two adult witnesses; there was no general default-surrogate statute until the Family Health Care Decisions Act (2010). Same-sex partners lacked legal standing

without a proxy.

- Medicine: three-vessel CAD and CABG; post-op A-fib treated with amiodarone and synchronized cardioversion; AVM embolization followed by resection; first-trimester nuchal translucency screening (normal under about 3 mm); stage IV neuroblastoma relapse after transplant. CaringBridge (founded 1997) is period-accurate.